

- ▶ **Lead:** It is used in soldering the circuit boards. Lead can cause damage to the central and peripheral nervous system, blood system and kidneys.
- ▶ **Mercury:** it is used in batteries and switches. Methylated Mercury forms when Mercury spreads out in water and that can cause brain damage.
- ▶ **Cadmium:** It is used in resistors for chips and in semiconductors. Cadmium accumulates in the kidneys and are proved to be quite harmful.

Green manufacturing

Green computing aims at using more eco-friendly materials during the manufacturing process of electronic products:

- ▶ **Bamboo:** It is used for making casings and computer peripherals.
- ▶ **Recyclable plastics:** Recyclable plastics are used instead of non-recyclable ones.
- ▶ **Eco-friendly Flame Retardants:** Silicon Compounds that are eco-friendly flame retardants and are non-toxic are used.
- ▶ **Inventory Management:** Green Computing tries to reduce the quantity of both hazardous and of excess raw materials that are used in the manufacturing process.

2. Energy consumption

Green computing aims to implement techniques to reduce energy consumption for efficient usage. Here are some simple things that you can follow to reduce energy consumption:

- ▶ Turn off your monitor when not in use and power down the CPU and other peripherals in extended periods of inactivity.
- ▶ Use LCD (Liquid-crystal-display) rather than CRT (Cathode-Ray-Tube) monitors.
- ▶ Use the power-management features to turn off hard drives and turn the computer to sleep after several minutes of inactivity.
- ▶ Try to opt for green batteries - manufactured with the techniques of Green Computing.
- ▶ Do not use air condition in the evenings. Open up the windows and let the cool breeze come in.
- ▶ Set your power settings to power-saving mode.
- ▶ Switch off non-useful background applications such as Bluetooth on your mobiles. They draw too much of battery.
- ▶ Try to use more of Green Laptops/PCs and printers. They are designed to consume lesser energy.